



PROGRESS REPORT

Botswana: progress report, August 2025 – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-27 • 108 systems and instruments tracked

GOVERNANCE • FINANCE • ICT INFRASTRUCTURE • DPI • DIGITALISATION • TECHNOLOGY • CAPACITY •
INCLUSION • DATA • GEOPOLITICS • WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

This report asks the same set of questions of every country. The rows below are a fixed frame of indicators, one row each, chosen in advance and covering all thirty-eight subjects the base tracks — so what appears here is decided by the frame and not by whichever records happened to accumulate. Each row says what happened on that indicator during the period, with every claim linked to the source it rests on.

Where a row reads *No evidence*, the base holds nothing on that indicator. **That is a statement about this base, not about the country** — it does not mean nothing exists, only that nothing has been collected here yet. The rows that carry evidence say what it is; the rows that do not are left to speak for themselves.

The period is 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-27.

Progress values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the base holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the base holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, regulations still pending*.

Governance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Digital transformation strategy	An ICT roadmap to 2030 targets 100,000 ICT jobs within five years and a double-digit sector share of output; its priorities appear as projects in no estimates volume. 2026-03-09 – a roadmap to 2030 was set out at a policy dialogue, targeting 100,000 ICT jobs within five years and a double-digit ICT share of national output , following ministerial priorities stated in November 2025 . The base does not establish when it was adopted, the document is not held, and its named priorities appear as projects in no estimates volume. The institution meant to carry it has not arrived. A Digital Services Authority was announced in the ministry's plan for the year with no establishing instrument found , and it was publicly contested as duplicative a year earlier . Nothing is on record being built. An e-waste strategy is the one instrument that did land: launched in July 2026 with an inter-agency memorandum, and no targets, budget, collection volumes or implementation dates published .	ADVANCED a blueprint with no budget trail behind it
Strategies, plans and policies	ICT strategy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Broadband strategy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data storage / cloud strategy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data interoperability framework / roadmap		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	AI strategy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data localisation policies	The minister stated an intention to compel businesses to store data in Botswana; no bill, draft or date is on file. 2025-11-25 – at the launch of the national data centre the minister announced an intention to amend the Data Protection Act to compel businesses to store data in Botswana . No bill, draft or date has followed in the nine months since, and nothing of the kind was proposed before. The Act as in force already permits transfer subject to approved-country limits and an in-country copy, so the announced amendment would replace a conditional regime with a compulsory one. The capacity to absorb it now exists: a certified national data centre and a private facility are reported under data storage, and government migration into the first is under way. What is missing is the instrument.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Data governance policy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Open data policy		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Data protection legislation	The 2024 Data Protection Act has been in force since January 2025, repealing a 2018 Act that never commenced; what moved in the window is enforcement. The Act came into force on 14 January 2025, repealing a 2018 statute that was never commenced . It did not change in the window. What changed is that it began to bite. The commission that had three contract officers, no premises, no published address and no website in July 2025 issued a determination and enforcement notice against a government directorate in July 2026 , reported under the authority below. The one amendment in prospect is the localisation duty reported under policy, which has no draft. No implementing regulations, codes of practice or approved-country list appear on this ledger.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	Cybersecurity legislation	The Cybersecurity Act was assented in November 2025 and gazetted, and was still not in force at the window's close, its stated April 2026 commencement having passed. 2025-11-05 – the Act was assented and gazetted on 11 November 2025, with commencement on notice , against a Bill only at the start of the window. Commencement was stated for April 2026 and that date passed with no notice on file. Section 3(2) excludes classified information held by eight security and revenue bodies. So the 2018 cybercrime statute remains the operative law, its repeal enacted and not commenced . The authority the Act creates is in the same position. It exists in law with a board, a chief executive, a licensing power over cybersecurity providers, a power to approve software before market placement and a critical-infrastructure mandate, and it is not established, with no organisation or vote in the year's estimates – an authority in law with no money at both the legal and the fiscal end.	ADVANCED made and gazetted but not in force
Legislation and regulation	Legislation covering digital id		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	Digital payments legislation	Electronic payment regulations were amended in April 2026, extending scope to value transfer services and reaching beneficial owners, with unlicensed operation punishable by P1,000,000 and five years. 2026-04-02 – amended regulations came into effect extending scope to money or value transfer services, taking fit-and-proper tests down to beneficial owners and 10% shareholders, and making unlicensed operation punishable by P1,000,000 and five years , with the central bank's implementation release in July . Float interest is ring-fenced and directed by the central bank, and financial-inclusion promotion was dropped from the permitted uses without being replaced by any customer entitlement – which is the change a wallet holder would notice if anyone told them. The virtual-asset regime is unchanged and still criticised: the Act is in force with crypto not legal tender , and a regional follow-up assessment in February 2026 still records provider-oversight shortcomings .	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	Legislation enabling data interoperability		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	AI legislation / regulations		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	E-commerce legislation		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Statistics legislation		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Access to information legislation		NO EVIDENCE
Data protection	Data protection authority	The commission suspended a government payslip portal by enforcement notice in July 2026, a year after operating with three contract officers and no premises. The starting position was an authority that barely existed: three contract officers, no premises, no published address, no website and no deputy commissioner in July 2025 . 2026-02-11 – it began enforcing against non-bank financial institutions , and 2026-07-17 – it issued a determination and enforcement notice against the public service management directorate, suspending the government payslip portal with compliance evidence due within a month . The directorate published a privacy notice on 6 July, completed an impact assessment on 13 July and added multi-factor authentication and a disaster-recovery plan, with no reopening date . The determination itself is not held; both accounts are press carries. It is the first published enforcement against a government body on this ledger, and the regulator still has no budget organisation or line of its own.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data protection	National data protection readiness		NO EVIDENCE
Regional collaboration	Regional policy collaboration	Two bilateral memoranda were signed in a fortnight — one with Namibia on transformation, cybersecurity, connectivity and skills — with no value or deliverable published for either. 2026-08-07 — the two countries' ICT ministries signed at Kasane with their operators and regulators, covering digital transformation, cybersecurity, connectivity and skills development, with the accompanying disclosure costing the remaining corridor coverage gaps at about N\$52 million across 13 new sites and recording the two national response teams deepening cooperation , announced two days before and confirmed on the day . No term, funding or data-governance provision is published and the signed instrument is not held. 2026-08-19 — the two countries' innovation agencies signed on cross-border innovation and technology commercialisation, framed by both as advancing the region's industrialisation agenda . No value, workstream, deliverable or duration is published. Two memoranda in a fortnight, neither costed, is the shape of this section: the delivered regional work is the roaming agreement and the fibre interconnection reported elsewhere.	ADVANCED
Regional collaboration	Regional legal harmonisation		NO EVIDENCE
Regional collaboration	Shared regional infrastructure	Regional roaming was extended to six states with cuts of between 10% and 98.6%, and a bid to host the regional internet exchange reached the final two. 2026-03-13 — the One Network Area was extended to five further states, making six, with roaming cuts of between 10% and 98.6%, data roaming to one neighbour down by up to 94% and incoming messages free across participants , against reduced rates with a single neighbour before. Engagement with one further state is stated as ongoing. 2025-11-27 — a bid to host the regional internet exchange was shortlisted to the final two , and no award decision is on record in the eight months since. Roaming is the one regional instrument in this report that reaches a citizen's bill directly, and it is also the one with a published effect.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Regional collaboration	Cross-border data transfers	Botswana is one of sixteen states in a regional cross-border identity and know-your-customer framework, with no national integration step, pilot or date held. 2025-08-26 – a regional cross-border digital public infrastructure and federated know-your-customer framework was set out by the regional central bank committee, naming Botswana among sixteen participating states . No Botswana-specific integration step, pilot or date is held, and the only prior real-time cross-border verification pilot named involves two other countries. 2026-06-15 – separately, existing agricultural systems are being assessed for integration into a regional agricultural information system at a four-day national readiness workshop , with no integration date or committed systems held. Both are readiness exercises. The domestic layer they would connect to is thin: there is no certificate-backed identity verification, reported under authentication, and no national data exchange appears anywhere on this ledger.	ADVANCED
Standards	National interoperability standards		NO EVIDENCE
Standards	National quality standards		NO EVIDENCE
Standards	Adoption of international standards	A candidature for the international radio regulations board is being promoted with member-state lobbying; the election has not been held. 2026-05 – a candidature for the international radio regulations board was promoted at a regional preparatory meeting, with member-state lobbying under way for the 2027-2030 term . The election has not been held and no baseline was held before this. It is the only standards-body engagement on this ledger. Domestically the picture is the opposite: no national address-protocol transition plan, target date or measured adoption figure exists, only a regulator training workshop, so a country seeking a seat on an international standards board has no published standards programme of its own.	ADVANCED
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Non-governmental contribution to national policy		NO EVIDENCE
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Open discussion of government policy		NO EVIDENCE

Finance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure	Sustainable domestic financing of digital transformation	Three digital capital lines were cut for the new year after outturns of 38.7%, 9.0% and nil; one small line rose and was fully spent. The pattern is appropriation followed by non-execution followed by a cut. The communications ministry ICT project falls to P251,000,000 after P369,079,545 appropriated and P142,712,599 spent, 38.7% , a third consecutive cut from P736.6m two years earlier . The research and development project falls to P213,700,000 after a 9.0% outturn ; its scope spans satellite, nuclear and biotechnology as well as digital. Basic education computerisation falls to P253,000,000 after P270,000,000 was appropriated, revised to P38,819,833 and nothing at all was spent — the vote behind the largest learning-technology award in this report. Two lines hold. Higher education computerisation rises to P16,000,000 after a full spend of P3,950,000 , the only clean-scope digital line with a 100% outturn, and the shared digital services recurrent vote is broadly flat at P587,310,850 , the largest single recurrent line. Outside the estimates entirely, P4.13bn was sought for revenue-service modernisation under the twelfth development plan , inside a P8.8bn digital ask , with no appropriation trail because the revenue service appears in no budget organisation. No audited outturn exists for any digital line in any year.	REGRESSED
MoUs and other agreements	Strategic relationships	An operator and the special economic zones authority signed a framework for connected utilities, smart security, digital platforms and connectivity, with no value stated. 2026-03-17 — a memorandum between a mobile operator and the special economic zones authority set a framework for connected utilities, smart security, digital platforms and connectivity inside the zones . No value is stated and the exact signature date is not published. It is the only operator-to-state framework on this ledger, and it is the one instrument here that ties connectivity to an industrial-policy vehicle rather than to a coverage target. No project, site or investment under it has been reported in the five months since.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
New investments	Mobilisation of non-state finance	A technology fund reached a GBP 5m first close against a GBP 50m target, and ten startups entered a twelve-month programme routed to a US\$150m fund. 2026-04-21 — a technology fund launched with a GBP 50m target, GBP 10m committed and a GBP 5m first close, writing tickets of GBP 25,000 to 100,000 for its accelerator and GBP 0.5m to 2m for growth , reported at first close . The GBP 50m is a target rather than capital raised, and a dollar headline circulating elsewhere converts the target rather than the raise. 2026-03-10 — a twelve-month programme for ten climate and digital startups launched, routed to a US\$150m decarbonisation fund , with the launch reported the following week . No Botswana-specific allocation from that fund is stated. Both are new and both are foreign-managed. No domestic venture capital, angel network or exit appears anywhere on this ledger.	ADVANCED
New investments	Development-partner project financing		NO EVIDENCE

ICT Infrastructure

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Mobile penetration		NO EVIDENCE
Connectivity	Internet usage	Penetration is put at 81.4% on 2.09m users at end-2025, against a regulator figure of about 73% three weeks earlier, and the two are unreconciled. 2025-11-26 — an end-2025 estimate puts internet users at 2.09m and penetration at 81.4% . It is a reference-study figure, and the regulator is separately reported at about 73% three weeks earlier , with the base reconciling neither against the other. No official penetration figure is held for the country at any date — only a venture fund's promotional claim and a reference study — so the eight-point spread between the two numbers in circulation cannot be settled. That matters more here than in most countries in this report, because the roadmap reported under strategy is built on an ICT share of output and a jobs target, and the denominator for both is a population whose connection rate the state does not publish.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Mobile affordability	The incumbent's prepaid data tariffs were cut with regulator approval on a pricing study, and a device-financing facility has published no uptake in fifteen months. 2026-02-18 – the regulator approved revised prepaid tariffs with immediate effect on a May 2025 pricing study: 1.5GB a day for P10, 4GB a month for P65, 30GB over 30 days for P199 and 100GB over 30 days for P349 . The other two operators revised earlier under the same study and their schedules are not held, so the market-wide effect cannot be stated. The device side has not moved. The country's first mobile device financing facility launched in May 2025 and has published no uptake, portfolio or default figure in the fifteen months since. A regulator-driven price cut with a published schedule is unusual in this report; what is missing is any measure of what it changed.	ADVANCED
Connectivity	National fibre backbone	About 16,000 km of fibre is stated laid, linking four neighbours, and a P43m local-access project connected three villages and 191 customers. 2026-03-09 – the minister put the network at about 16,000 km of fibre laid, linking South Africa, Namibia, Zimbabwe and Zambia , a statement with no published register behind it. 2026-08-16 – a P43m local-access programme completed, extending fibre to three villages and connecting 191 customers with 210 construction jobs created , by an operator reporting P376m revenue and 99.7% availability across the backbone , confirmed in a third account . Against those figures, a Village Connectivity Project is stated as running with no site count, target, budget or completion date published : the state names the programme and publishes no figure against it, while the wholesale operator publishes down to the customer.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	International internet bandwidth	A first direct cross-border fibre link with Namibia was completed and interconnected, while the only national traffic figure held remains just over 100Gbps from February 2025. 2026-08-10 – the Namibian operator completed the Gobabis-Buitepos link, now interconnecting at Charles Hill, which the two sides describe as the first direct cross-border fibre link between them , against a memorandum only in February 2026 . No capacity, commissioning date or traffic figure is published for the link and the corridor beyond it is not reported delivered. 2026-07-06 – a second corridor's first phase is live at 800Gbps on equipment rated over 10Tbps, with phase two due September 2026 ; it is described as a three-country corridor and the live section is inside a neighbour, with no Botswana segment dated. Measurement has not moved with the build. International traffic was just over 100Gbps in February 2025, up from under 8Gbps in 2015, after a P100m gateway upgrade , and no later figure has been published – the only national capacity figure the base holds, eighteen months old at the window's close.	ADVANCED
Connectivity	Internet Exchange Points		NO EVIDENCE
Connectivity	Satellite broadband licensing and availability	The incumbent connected 61 rural villages by satellite with 105 areas in progress, and no update has been published since November 2025. 2025-11-28 – the incumbent operator reported 61 rural villages connected by satellite – schools, clinics and community centres – with 105 further areas in process , announced with half-year results. No baseline preceded it and no update has followed in nine months. That is the whole of the satellite record for the country: no licensing decision, no low-earth-orbit operator, no tariff and no subscriber figure appears. The one place a satellite operator does appear is in a risk register – the state wholesale operator escalated low-earth-orbit competition to its board as a structural disruption, reported under national production capacity.	ADVANCED on one programme with nothing reported since

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (all providers)	A gas-powered private data centre completed its first full quarter of continuous operation, and a solar campus aimed at hyperscale compute remains a memorandum. 2026-08-03 – a private data centre reached its first full quarter of continuous operation for the quarter ended 30 June 2026, fully commissioned, with revenue the company describes as modest and at proof-of-concept scale, designed for up to 1MW with expansion subject to funding , against a first module under commissioning with generators en route and no revenue in September 2025 . 2025-10-02 – a solar-powered campus targeted at hyperscale and artificial-intelligence compute is at memorandum stage inside a planned energy hub and industrial park , reported as a Dutch and American venture , with no capacity, cost, site approval or timeline and nothing on file since. One small facility running and one large one on paper is the private half of the country's storage capacity; the state half is reported above.	ADVANCED
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (national providers)	The state data centre is in operation, Tier III certified and carrier-neutral, with critical government services migrated and the mid-2026 phase unconfirmed. 2025-11-25 – the state-owned data centre launched after Tier III certification in October 2025, carrier-neutral, offering storage, hosting and exchange , against a facility built but neither certified nor launched at the window's opening. 2026-05-06 – critical government services have been migrated, with the initial phase targeted for mid-2026 and no confirmation on file that it completed , against a stated intention to migrate services held at the shared digital services department . A second data centre is stated as planned with nothing further on file. The facility is the physical precondition for the localisation duty announced under policy, and the migration is the test of it – reported, so far, only in the words "critical services".	ADVANCED
Data Storage	Off-site backup capacity		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Energy	Sufficient energy and water for data centres	The operating data centre runs on on-site gas supplemented by solar, and its expansion is gated on a gas gathering extension subject to funding. 2026-08-03 – on-site gas-fired generation is now supplemented by solar, with battery and compressed-gas storage under review , where renewables had been named for future phases only. Solar is specified as firming for gas, which is the reverse of the usual diesel-backup pattern. The constraint on growth is upstream. An extension of the gas gathering network to connect a further production well is stated as subject to funding, and it gates the data centre's capacity expansion , while an initial 5MW solar development has been assessed with no capital cost, approval or date . The company states these are work-programme items rather than guidance. At the other site, 250MW of solar with a foreseen 100-400MW battery system is under development on a developer statement, with no financial close, permit or grid connection on file. Data-centre growth here is gated on energy work, not on demand.	ADVANCED
Energy	Grid reliability		NO EVIDENCE
Energy	Rural electrification		NO EVIDENCE
Technical Capacity	Robustness of government hardware and software	The government accounting and budgeting system was told to a parliamentary committee to be fully operational after a December 2024 upgrade, with more than 20,000 users. The committee of supply was told the software upgrade completed in December 2024 and the system is fully operational, with more than 20,000 users . No later statement, availability figure or upgrade has been held since, so the position is unchanged across the window. A further upgrade sits inside the finance ministry's development-plan allocation reported under central-bank payments governance, undated and unpriced separately. It is the only whole-of-government administrative system on this ledger with a user count attached, and the count is eighteen months old.	NO CHANGE
Technical Capacity	Local capacity to maintain, manage and develop government systems		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Cybersecurity	National cybersecurity readiness	A four-day national cyber drill was held and a vendor security portfolio entered the market; no national strategy or authority exists. 2026-03 – a four-day national cyber drill was held, opened by the regulator's chief executive , where none was on file at the start of the window; the base separately records an inaugural drill in the same season. 2026-05-13 – an integrated security framework and cloud services became available to Botswana customers , on a company announcement with no customer, revenue or capacity figures. The measured position is good and thinly sourced: 0.9% of consumer transaction attempts were flagged as suspected digital fraud in 2025, the lowest of the African countries analysed , on a vendor study paywalled beyond its opening paragraph. What is missing is the institutional half. No national cybersecurity strategy document, date or version is on file, and the authority that would own one is created in law and not established, reported under legislation.	ADVANCED on exercises and vendor services rather than on institutions

DPI

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	National data exchange system		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Use of digital id in other systems		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Interoperability of health systems		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Interoperability of education systems		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Interoperability of social protection systems		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	Robustness of system	A biometric card is itemised at P31,700,000 in the new estimates, while card replacement has been delayed since the start of 2026 on staffing and ageing equipment. 2026-04-01 – the electronic identification programme was rescoped from a public-private partnership into a broader digital identity estate integrating a national wallet and electronic government services, with a biometric identity card itemised at P31,700,000 , against a partnership prioritised the year before and not progressed . Against that, the physical system is failing. A parliamentary answer attributes replacement delays running since the start of 2026 to too few production staff and ageing equipment with frequent breakdowns, with no backlog figure, no restoration date and no equipment-replacement commitment . The legislative patch is in force and not working as intended: an amendment allows a passport or driving licence to serve while a card is replaced , and service providers are reported refusing even the replacement receipt .	MIXED a digital identity programme rescoped and funded while physical card production degraded
Digital Identity and CRVS	Registration of entire population		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	National maintenance of id and credentials systems		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Authentication	The public key infrastructure is funded, begun, incomplete and non-operational, with P423m secured and control transferred to the intelligence directorate. 2026-07-30 – the public accounts committee was told the project is funded, begun, incomplete and non-operational: P423m secured, control transferred to the intelligence directorate, no working system, no timeline and no accountable owner . The ministry's own headline figure appears as both P420m and P423m in the single account. The consequence is stated plainly in the same source: the country has no certificate-backed identity verification and no recognised electronic-signature layer. That is the missing floor under everything else in this report. The services portal, the payslip portal, the rescoped digital identity and the regional know-your-customer framework all assume a trust layer that P423m has not produced.	STALLED
Digital Identity and CRVS	Digital id from birth		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Interoperability of birth registration and digital id		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	Use by other systems	Identity-linked SIM registration has been mandatory for all users since March 2024, with no later regulator statement or registration rate held. Registration has been mandatory for all users since a public notice of March 2024 . Nothing has moved it: no later regulator statement, registration rate or de-registration figure is held. It is the only case on this ledger of the national identity being required by another system, and it is the oldest instrument in this section. Nothing states what identity document satisfies it, which matters against the card replacement failures reported above, or how it is verified without the certificate layer the country does not have.	NO CHANGE
Digital Payments and Fintech	Governance role of central bank	A national payment switch is funded in plan only, inside a P486m allocation covering four projects together, with no build, procurement, operator or date. 2025-10-31 — a national payment switch is named inside a P486m ICT allocation sought under the twelfth development plan , part of a P8.8bn digital ask . The allocation covers the switch, an accounting-system upgrade, a sandbox and electronic procurement together, and the switch carries no separate figure. No build, procurement, operator or date is on the record. So domestic interbank routing has no national infrastructure and no dated plan, while the cross-border corridor reported below is live and the payments regulations were tightened in April. The central bank's visible action in the window is regulatory rather than infrastructural.	NO CHANGE
Digital Payments and Fintech	G2P functionality	Biometric grant cards stand at more than 75,000 beneficiaries and 1,200 shops, the same figure as a year ago, and the announced citizen wallet has had no follow-up. The biometric grant payment system reached more than 75,000 beneficiaries and 1,200 shops on a platform accredited by three central banks , and the same figure is all the base holds . No update has been published in the twelve months, and the figure is restated elsewhere under a 2026 heading where it reads as current. 2025-09-17 — a unified Citizen Wallet for subsidy delivery was presented to a rural development council alongside a cryptographic card . Nothing further has appeared in ten months on either. So government-to-person payment in Botswana is one closed-loop card scheme whose numbers have not moved, and a wallet that exists in a presentation.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	Revenue collection	Value added tax on non-resident digital services took effect in June 2026 with a collection target of about P450m a year, and electronic invoicing is provided for with no start date. 2026-06-01 – a 14% value added tax on non-resident digital and remote services took effect, with a stated collection target of about P450m a year , the revenue service having set out its intent to tax global digital providers , against a tax system described three months earlier as built for tangible goods . 2026-08-16 – mandatory electronic invoicing is provided for by the 2025 value added tax statute in force from 1 July 2026, with no start date, threshold or scope published . The account is a tax adviser's reading of the Act; no revenue-service notice or timetable is on record. The system that would carry both is unfunded through the estimates: P4.13bn for revenue-service modernisation, covering electronic invoicing, digital taxation and border infrastructure, sits in a development plan with no appropriation trail .	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	B2B and B2G functionality		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Payments and Fintech	P2P, P2G and P2B functionality		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	Population uptake	A remittance wallet gained a card for cash withdrawal and in-store payment, and a bank and a taxi association launched card acceptance with loans conditioned on the banking history it builds. 2026-08-18 – a card issued against a remittance wallet balance added cash withdrawal, in-store payment and domestic online payment to a wallet that previously carried transfer and cash-out only, with no separate bank account required, working across every mobile network, each transaction protected by a code and a lost card blockable from the handset , launched the day before . The operator puts the gap it addresses at 38 per cent of adults unbanked against mobile penetration of 164 per cent . 2026-08-09 – a commercial bank and a taxi association launched card acceptance on the bank's tap product for taxi operators, with access to business loans of up to P60,000 conditioned on a formal banking history built through it . It is a single bank's product with a single association, no operator count or fee schedule is stated, and the loan access is tied to banking with the same institution. Both arrived in the last three weeks of the window and both route the unbanked into the formal system through a private product rather than a public rail.	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	Cross-border functionality	An instant regional corridor went live inbound from two neighbours in March 2026, and card e-commerce acceptance was extended across nine markets. 2026-03-02 – an instant cross-border corridor went live inbound from South Africa and Zimbabwe , rolled through a commercial bank , where no live regional instant corridor into the country existed. No volume or value figure for the corridor is held. 2026-08-19 – online acceptance of a foreign card scheme opened to participating merchants across nine African markets, settling in local currency, dollars or both , extending a collaboration running since 2024 . Nearly 900 participating merchants across the nine markets and about 7 million cards issued in Africa are the two companies' own figures, with no Botswana-specific count. Cross-border rails are ahead of domestic ones here, which is the reverse of the usual order and follows from the absent national switch.	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	Consumer protection		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Population register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Civil register		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Address register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Business register	The enterprise agency ran nationwide consultations to March-May 2026 and is lobbying for mandatory small-business registration; no database is in build. 2026-04-29 – nationwide consultations ran from March to May 2026 with the enterprise agency lobbying for mandatory registration of small and medium enterprises into a national database . It is proposed only: no instrument, no penalties intended and no database in build. Nothing else on this ledger touches business registration, so the country's record here is a consultation and an intention. The comparison worth making is with the taxi financing product reported under payment uptake, where formalisation is being achieved by a bank offering credit against a transaction history rather than by a register compelling registration.	ADVANCED a proposal with no instrument behind it
Registries	Social protection register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Electoral register	P50,000,000 was appropriated for electronic voter registration, with government committing to a reform package built on one-time registration and a verified electronic roll. 2026-08-19 – government committed in Parliament to an electoral-reform package built on one-time voter registration, the national identity card and a verified electronic voters' roll accessible to political parties , after the commission pressed for digital reform in June . P50,000,000 is appropriated within the commission's development budget – the first time the voter register carries a price in any document held. The package has no bill, timetable or procurement on record. 2026-07-06 – an elections management system is built and under extensive testing, replacing platforms developed in the 1990s, with deployment planned for the 2029 general election , and no supplier, cost or acceptance date held. The commission's secretary separately states, as personal opinion, that voters do not want electronic voting machines. The reform rests on the identity card, whose replacement service is failing, reported under digital identity.	ADVANCED
Registries	Tax register		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Land register	The deeds registry remains substantially manual on a workload of 9,000 to 30,000 transactions a year, with no digitisation programme, budget line or date on the record. 2025-10-15 – the deputy registrar described a registry that is substantially manual, carrying 9,000 to 30,000 transactions a year since the 2017-18 land Acts with no added resources . Nothing has moved it since, and no digitisation programme, budget line or date appears. About 70% of the country's land is tribal land, brought into registration by the 2018 Tribal Land Act , so the workload the manual registry carries is the product of a deliberate widening of what must be registered. It is the clearest untouched administrative system in this report: every other registry described here is either being built, tested or funded, and this one is not on anybody's list.	NO CHANGE
Sectoral management information systems	Health		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Education		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Social protection		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Justice		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Tax		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Customs		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Land		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Other GovTech and e-Gov	e-government services	Electronic services rose from 33 to 52 under a Digital Services Act in force with a compliance clock to November 2027, while the payslip portal went offline. 2026-03-18 – the government services platform records electronic services increased from 33 to 52, including teacher registration, appointment scheduling and business facilitation . No usage, transaction or uptake figure is held for either end. The Digital Services Act came into force on 21 November 2025 with a 24-month compliance window running to November 2027 , the clock confirmed in February . 2026-07-22 – against that, the government payslip portal is offline with no reopening date after the data-protection regulator's enforcement notice, a privacy notice, an impact assessment, multi-factor authentication and disaster recovery having been added since . It is the only government system on this ledger taken offline by the regulator. Procurement has not moved: the electronic procurement system is still due at the beginning of 2027, and the authority still states it has no real-time data on procurement transactions , against a strategy approved in June 2025.	MIXED the services platform grew from 33 to 52 while the regulator took a government portal offline

Digitalisation

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digitalisation of sub-national government	ICT infrastructure for local government		NO EVIDENCE
Digitalisation of sub-national government	Digitalisation of local government records		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural health clinics		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural primary schools		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural registry offices		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural police stations		NO EVIDENCE

Technology

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Use of AI in government administration	The Chief Justice stated that the judiciary had resolved to train judges in artificial intelligence and emerging technologies; no programme, budget or date is on record. 2026-01-22 — the Chief Justice stated that the judiciary had resolved to train judges in artificial intelligence and emerging technologies, against cases involving artificial intelligence and digital evidence . A commitment is stated and no programme, budget, date or filing rollout is on record. It is the only state-side artificial-intelligence commitment the base holds for the country, and it is a training resolution rather than a deployment. No government system on this ledger uses artificial intelligence, and no national policy, strategy or regulatory instrument is held at any date.	ADVANCED
AI	Use of AI in sectoral management information systems		NO EVIDENCE
AI	Development of national / regional AI systems	Adoption sits at 0 to 0.40 chatbot visits per internet user a month on a 0 to 2.6 scale, among the lowest measured. 2025-12-12 — a readiness framing puts artificial-intelligence adoption at 0 to 0.40 chatbot visits per internet user a month on a scale to 2.6, among the lowest adopters, in a band covering about 45% of Africa . It is a reference study, cited and not absorbed, and the source is paywalled after two paragraphs. Nothing on this ledger records a model, dataset, laboratory or application built in the country. The compute that would host one is being built for export rather than for domestic research: the solar campus reported under data storage is targeted at hyperscale and artificial-intelligence workloads and remains a memorandum. An offer of cooperation arrived from outside, reported under geopolitics, and no national response is on file.	NO CHANGE
AI	Control of AI abuse		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
ICT Industry	National capacity in DT-related production	The state wholesale operator's revenue fell to P376m from P485m and the incumbent's profit fell 45% to P146.2m, both against rising service volumes. 2026-08-13 – the state wholesale operator's first integrated report puts revenue for the year ended 31 March 2025 at P376m against P485m the year before, alongside 71% national broadband penetration, 206 villages connected to the backbone, 17,586 homes covered with fibre to the home, 1,272 public wireless premises and a fifth consecutive year of profitability without government subvention . It manages access to three international submarine systems and escalated two material risks to its board: disruption from low-earth-orbit satellite operators, and liquidity pressure from declining wholesale revenues. The financial statements are audited; the non-financial disclosures are not. 2026-07-06 – the listed incumbent's profit before tax fell 45% to P146.2m on revenue of P1.47bn, down 1.6% , against a prior year in which data and broadband demand pushed revenue up . Two state-linked operators carrying the national network, both with falling returns, is the industrial position underneath every connectivity figure in this report.	REGRESSED
Innovation ecosystem	Technology hubs		NO EVIDENCE
Innovation ecosystem	Tech startup ecosystem		NO EVIDENCE

Capacity

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Literacy	Digital literacy (civil service)	Regulators from four countries began geographic-information and data-management training in Botswana under a continental broadband mapping project. 2026-06-01 – subregional geographic-information and data-management training commenced in Botswana with the regulator and the regional association, attended by regulators from Botswana, Malawi, Zambia and Zimbabwe under a continental broadband maps project . Nothing preceded it and the publisher is a wire service flagged in the source. It is the only public-sector capability activity on this ledger. Its subject is mapping, which is also the country's clearest data gap: no broadband map has been published, reported under administrative statistics, and the fibre network's own length rests on a ministerial statement with no register behind it.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Literacy	Digital literacy (general population)	The regulator ran information and cyber-awareness sessions at four schools in January 2026; no national coverage figure exists. 2026-01-22 – the regulator ran information and communications technology and cyber-awareness sessions at four schools , on a wire source flagged at ingest. No baseline preceded it and no national coverage figure is published. No dated national digital-literacy or digital-skills rate is held for the country at any date. So four schools is the entire measured literacy activity of the window, against a services platform carrying 52 electronic services and a tax regime that now reaches online purchases.	ADVANCED
Training and skills	DT-related training in secondary education	A P654.4m schools coding and robotics contract was awarded by direct procurement, its financial evaluation received, adjudicated and approved the same day. 2026-06-25 – a contract for a schools electronic-learning, coding and robotics programme was awarded by direct procurement at P654.4m, with the financial evaluation received, adjudicated and approved on the same day and the decision published on 8 July . An appeal court cleared the procurement route about six months earlier; that judgment is not held, and this rests on a paywalled opening paragraph. The vote behind it spent nothing in the preceding year: basic education computerisation was appropriated at P270,000,000, revised to P38,819,833 and executed at zero . So the largest single digital award in this report was made by direct procurement in one day, from a budget line with no track record of spending, for a programme with no published curriculum, school count or timetable.	ADVANCED
Training and skills	DT-related university facilities and qualifications	The university launched the country's first virtual-reality programme, giving remote access to its laboratories. 2026-04-16 – the country's first local virtual-reality programme launched with a partner innovation hub, giving remote access to university laboratories . Nothing of the kind existed before it and no user numbers, cost or funder is on record. Remote laboratory access is the right instrument for a country whose higher-education computerisation vote is P16,000,000 – the smallest clean-scope digital line in the estimates and the only one fully spent. No degree programme, department or graduate count in a digital discipline appears anywhere on this ledger.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Training and skills	Graduates entering DT ecosystem	A labour market information system is near completion, with only facilitation and training remaining; no go-live date, cost or supplier is held. 2026-06-08 – the permanent secretary told a parliamentary committee that only facilitation and training remain before the labour market information system goes live , on a paywalled opening paragraph, with no go-live date, cost or supplier held. No baseline preceded it. Until it runs, the country has no instrument that could answer this indicator: no graduate count, no placement rate and no sector employment figure appears on this ledger, against a roadmap whose headline commitment is 100,000 technology jobs within five years .	ADVANCED
Research institutions	Think tanks and academic departments contributing to DT policy	The national research agenda spent P9.5m across the same 45 projects in the year, five completed and none added. 2026-03-25 – P9.5m was spent across 45 projects, five completed and no new projects added, on an agenda Cabinet approved in July 2025 with eight focus areas and 22 thematic priorities . The 45 were approved in 2024 and carried forward, so the project count is unchanged for a second year. A research agenda that adds nothing in a year is not a pipeline. Nothing on this ledger records a think tank, a policy institute or a university department contributing to digital policy, and the roadmap reported under strategy names no research input.	NO CHANGE

Inclusion

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Citizen feedback portals		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Citizen participation in policy		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Gender equity		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Inclusion of persons with disabilities		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Inclusion of refugees and IDPs		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital divides	Bridging of digital divides	The universal fund handed over two school digital centres at P1.45m and P1.5m per site, while the single community wireless site has had no successor in fourteen months. 2026-07-22 – two school digital centres were handed over in one district at P1.45m and P1.5m per site, thirty machines each , the second framed as addressing the rural divide . The fund is a 1% levy on mobile service providers , no programme total or school target is published, and the base carried nothing on its school programme before January 2026. Against that, the community wireless site launched in June 2025 with tariffs of P2 to P10 and a free 45-minute daily window remains the only one , with no second site recorded in fourteen months. Two laboratories and one hotspot is the whole of the published inclusion delivery, against an unresolved dispute about what the national penetration rate even is, reported under internet usage.	ADVANCED

Data

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	National strategy for development of statistics	A second statistics development strategy for 2026 to 2030 was launched in August 2026, and a substantive statistician general took post. 2026-08-12 – the second statistics development strategy for 2026 to 2030 launched, aligned to the twelfth national development plan, jointly with the university . No budget, delivery milestones or indicator set is published with it. 2025-10 – a substantive statistician general was appointed, succeeding an acting holder, with data quality described by a named analyst as worryingly uneven . Both are institutional repairs rather than outputs, and the unevenness the analyst names is visible throughout this report: two irreconcilable internet penetration figures, a fibre length with no register behind it, and a grant-payment figure restated a year later as if current.	ADVANCED
National statistics	Censuses and surveys		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	Statistics from administrative data	Subregional broadband mapping training is under way with three neighbours; no Botswana broadband map has been published. 2026-06-01 — geographic-information and data-management training is under way in Botswana with Malawi, Zambia and Zimbabwe under a continental broadband maps project, and no Botswana broadband map has been published . The publisher is a wire service, flagged in the source frontmatter. A published coverage map would settle several of the disputes in this report at once: where the fibre network actually runs, which villages the connectivity project has reached, and what the difference is between the two penetration figures in circulation. The training is the first step toward one and no output date is stated.	ADVANCED
Open data	Use of open data		NO EVIDENCE
Use of satellite data	Agricultural use of satellite data	The national hyperspectral satellite is in orbit with commercialisation still stated as the next phase, and no product, customer or revenue is held. The satellite launched in March 2025 with an in-country ground station, hyperspectral, with data commercialisation stated as the next phase ; 2026-03-18 — commercialisation is still stated as the next phase , with no product, customer or revenue held. Hyperspectral imagery is the instrument for crop, rangeland and mineral analysis, and no agricultural, environmental or land-management use of it appears anywhere on this ledger — including in the deeds registry reported under land, which remains substantially manual. A satellite in orbit for eighteen months with no named user is the clearest instance in this report of capability arriving ahead of any application for it.	NO CHANGE
Use of satellite data	Meteorological use of satellite data		NO EVIDENCE

Geopolitics

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
US / hyperscaler activities	USA / hyperscaler MoUs, engagements and commitments	Botswana signed the Artemis Accords as the 68th signatory in June 2026, about fifteen months after its satellite launch. 2026-06-25 — the accords were signed at the American space agency's headquarters, making the country the 68th signatory , about fifteen months after the national satellite launch. It is a wire account and the signed instrument is not held. It is the only United States engagement on this ledger and it concerns space rather than digital infrastructure. No American technology vendor, cloud provider or financing instrument appears in the record for the country at any date, which is unusual for a middle-income economy with a certified data centre and a listed incumbent operator.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
China activities	Chinese MoUs, engagements and commitments	China's ambassador publicly offered artificial-intelligence cooperation in smart mining, digital government and talent training; a vendor academy runs at five universities. 2026-08-25 — the ambassador publicly offered cooperation on artificial intelligence in smart mining, digital government and talent training, pitching it as a lever for economic diversification and pointing to a July 2026 pledge of 5,000 training places for developing countries and application cooperation centres for bodies including the African Union . It is an offer rather than an instrument: no Botswanan response, memorandum or programme is on file. The delivered engagement is educational. A vendor academy operates with five tertiary institutions, certifying in cloud, networking, data management and cybersecurity , with a competition run across five named universities in 2025-26 . The source reads as vendor-supplied copy and no student numbers or funding are held. An offer of artificial-intelligence cooperation lands in a country with no artificial-intelligence policy and adoption among the lowest measured, reported above.	ADVANCED
EU activities	EU MoUs, engagements and commitments	A EUR 1,500,000 digital transformation facility committed in 2022 still shows nothing disbursed. A cooperation facility for digital transformation was committed in 2022 with an activity period running to 2030, at EUR 1,500,000, with nothing disbursed at the record's access date . It is a grant record only and no delivery milestone on the Botswana side is held. Four years of a nine-year facility with no disbursement is the position. The minister has named three European states assisting on legal-framework alignment, and no instrument, value or timeframe for that assistance is stated anywhere on this ledger — so the European contribution to the country's digital statutes is visible in outcomes and invisible in documents.	NO CHANGE
Gulf/UAE activities	Gulf MoUs, engagements and commitments	Heads of agreement with a Gulf counterparty on the private data centre are unchanged, and the counterparty is not named in the operator's latest quarterly account. Heads of agreement with a Gulf counterparty were negotiated in March 2025 with site and technical planning progressed by September 2025 ; 2026-08-03 — the counterparty is not named in the operator's quarterly account . It is the only Gulf instrument the base holds for the country at any date, and the silence is the finding: the data centre it concerned is now commissioned and reporting revenue, reported under storage, with no statement of whether the agreement survived into the operating phase.	NO CHANGE
India activities	India MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
National Cybersecurity Strategy	the strategy document itself, or a gazette notice or ministerial statement giving its date of adoption and version	not yet probed
National IPv6 transition plan	a regulator or ministry IPv6 transition plan with a target date, or a published IPv6 adoption percentage for Botswana	not yet probed
National open-data portal or policy	a named national open-data portal, a Cabinet-approved open-data policy, or a statistics-office dataset register with a publication date	not yet probed
EU-Botswana digital cooperation instrument since 2022	a named Global Gateway or development package for Botswana with a value and a signature date	not yet probed
Local-government digital systems	a local-government ministry committee-of-supply speech naming council systems, or a named council-level rates, licensing or land-allocation platform with a dated statement	not yet probed
National AI policy or strategy	a gazetted national AI policy, or the development plan's AI policy project producing a published document	not yet probed
India-Botswana technology or digital cooperation	any India-Botswana memorandum, line of credit, training record or Indian vendor contract naming Botswana	not yet probed
Official internet penetration figure	the regulator's annual report, or a statistics-office household ICT access survey	not yet probed
National digital literacy measure	a dated statistics-office or regulator household ICT survey reporting a digital-literacy or digital-skills rate	not yet probed
Universal fund annual allocation and school target	the regulator's annual report, or the universal fund's own accounts	not yet probed
Audited outturn for digital budget lines	the Auditor General's report on the accounts of the Government of Botswana for FY2024/25 or FY2025/26	not yet probed

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